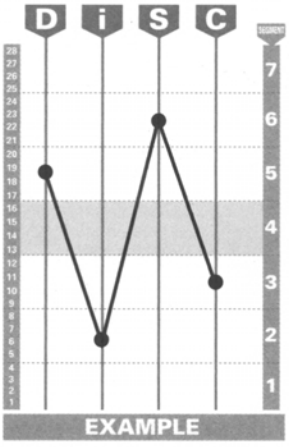
Achiever Pattern



Emotions: is industrious and diligent; displays frustration

Goal: personal accomplishments, sometimes at the expense of the group's goal

Judges others by: ability to achieve concrete results

Influences others by: accountability for own work

Value to the organization: sets and completes key result areas for self

Overuses: reliance on self; absorption in the task

Under pressure: becomes frustrated and impatient; becomes more of a "do-er" and less of a "delegator"

Fears: others with competing or inferior work standards affecting results

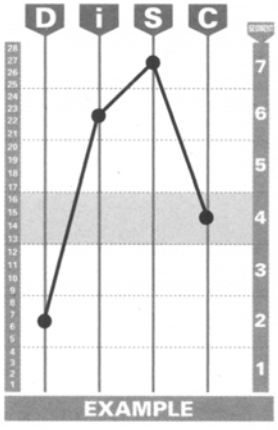
Would increase effectiveness with: reduction of "either-or" thinking; clarity of task priority; consideration of optional approaches; willingness to compromise short-term for long-range benefits

The motivation of Achievers is largely internal and flows from deeply felt personal goals. Their commitment to their own goals precludes an automatic acceptance of the group's goals. Achievers need to see how they can blend their personal goals with the organization's goals. By retaining control over the direction of their lives, Achievers develop a strong sense of accountability.

Achievers demonstrate a keen interest in their work and an intense, continual pursuit of accomplishment. They have a high opinion of their work and under pressure may hesitate to delegate tasks. Instead, they take on the work themselves to ensure that things are done right. When they delegate, they have a tendency to take back the task if it does not go according to their expectations. Their guiding premise is, "If I succeed, I want the credit, and if I fail, I will take the blame."

An Achiever should communicate more with others to expand their thinking beyond either "I have to do it myself" or "I want all the credit." They may need assistance to find new approaches for achieving their desired results. Achievers function at peak efficiency, and they expect recognition equal to their contribution – high wages in for-profit organizations and leadership positions in other groups.

Agent Pattern



Emotions: accepts affection; rejects aggression

Goal: group acceptance

Judges others by: commitment to tolerate and include everyone

Influences others by: empathy; friendship

Value to the organization: supports, harmonizes, empathizes; focuses on service

Overuses: kindness

Under pressure: becomes persuasive, using information or key friendships if necessary

Fears: dissension; conflict

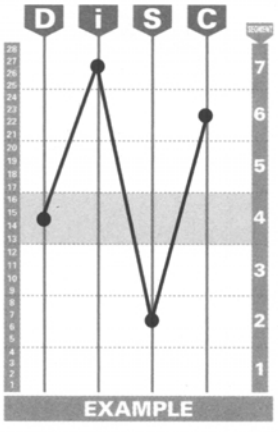
Would increase effectiveness with: strength in the realization of who they are and what they can do; firmness and self-assertion; ability to say "no" when appropriate

Agents are attentive to both the human relations and task aspects of their work situation. Empathetic and supportive, they are good listeners and known for their willing ear. Agents make people feel wanted and needed. Because Agents respond to others' needs, people do not fear being rejected by Agents. Agents offer friendship and are willing to perform services for others.

Agents have excellent potential for effectively organizing and completing tasks. Agents naturally promote harmony and teamwork and are particularly good at doing for others what they find difficult to do for themselves.

Agents fear conflict and dissension. Their supportive approach may enable others to tolerate a situation, rather than encouraging them to engage in active problem-solving. In addition, the Agent's tendency to adopt a "low" profile – instead of having open confrontations with aggressive individuals – may be perceived as a lack of "toughness." Although they are concerned with fitting into the group, Agents have a fair degree of independence.

Appraiser Pattern



Emotions: is driven to look good

Goal: "victory" with flair

Judges others by: ability to initiate activities

Influences others by: competitive recognition

Value to the organization: accomplishes goals with the team

Overuses: authority; ingenuity

Under pressure: becomes restless, critical, impatient

Fears: "loss" or "failure"; others' disapproval

Would increase effectiveness with: individual follow-through; empathy when showing disapproval; steadier pace

Appraisers make creative ideas serve practical purposes. They use direct methods to accomplish results. Appraisers are competitive, but other people tend to view them as assertive rather than aggressive because Appraisers are considerate of others. Instead of giving orders or commands, Appraisers involve people in the task through persuasion. They elicit the cooperation of those around them by explaining the rationale of the proposed activities.

Appraisers help others visualize the steps that are necessary to accomplish results. Appraisers usually speak from a detailed plan of action that they have developed to ensure an orderly progression toward results. In their eagerness to win, Appraisers can become impatient when their standards are not maintained or when extensive follow-through is required.

Appraisers are good critical thinkers. They are verbal in their criticisms, and their words occasionally may be caustic. Appraisers have better control of the situation if they relax and pace themselves. A helpful axiom to achieve this is, "You win some and you lose some."

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